

Reflections on Language and Painting

I think we are all acutely aware of the inherent limitations of language.

First, there are the obvious boundaries imposed by different linguistic systems. Individuals speaking entirely different languages face an immediate breakdown in communication. This systemic barrier is slightly mitigated among languages within the same linguistic family; for instance, when a French speaker interacts with a Spanish speaker—whether through text or face-to-face—they can often decipher fragmented meanings even with zero prior exposure to the other's language. However, such intuitive decoding is entirely impossible between a Chinese speaker and an English speaker.

Furthermore, even when two individuals share the exact same native tongue and face no structural linguistic barriers, does that guarantee a friction-free transmission of data?

In reality, instances where individuals share a common language yet fail to communicate smoothly are remarkably frequent. This necessitates a rigorous definition of what "smooth communication" actually entails. Does it mean the mere successful exchange of data qualify? When information is exchanged purely to express emotion or cultivate mutual understanding, how do we verify that a genuine cognitive consensus has been reached post-dialogue? If two recipients hear the identical transmission but prioritize entirely different key matrices, yet ultimately confirm a congruent outcome, does that constitute successful communication? Under a strict analytical definition, seamless and optimal communication appears to be nothing more than a non-continuous, low-probability event.

Naturally, we tend to attribute these communication failures to fundamental variables such as cultural-cognitive divergence and environmental conditioning. Yet, identifying the causal factors does not resolve the systemic issue. The core objective of any communication system is to transfer information between agents with the maximum degree of fidelity and completeness. The structural limitation of language lies in the fact that we are confined to arranging and permeating an artificially constructed vocabulary; consequently, semantic drift frequently occurs, leaving our output misaligned with our true intent. Even in rare cases where the semantic mapping is precise, the language system cannot guarantee that the recipient will synthesize the exact same subjective experience or cognitive perception.

Moreover, I argue that the increased efficiency and accessibility of modern textual communication inversely correlate with its precision, leading to a degradation in information fidelity. When the barriers to entry are lowered, allowing an oversaturated volume of opinions to be published instantly, it encroaches upon an agent's cognitive bandwidth—specifically, the capacity and intent required to understand others. This hyper-acceleration of output ultimately renders individual expression imprecise, superficial, and devoid of rigorous contemplation.

Therefore, I propose that works of art function as a higher-precision medium of expression than verbal language. To be clear: it is a higher-precision medium, not a higher-efficiency one. Every communicative modality possesses its own optimized utility.

Painting initiates from a state of total void—a blank canvas stripped of pre-conditioned parameters and systemic constraints. Yet, it is precisely within this unconstrained system that an agent is forced into rigorous contemplation: *What exactly are you attempting to model? Or, what is the other agent projecting?* The removal of systemic boundaries unlocks absolute freedom, which inherently introduces a corresponding rise in entropy—bringing forth chaos, cognitive friction, and structural challenges. This trade-off is universal.

Artistic artifacts, such as paintings, prompt a systematic parsing of experience: *Within what specific contextual parameters did I experience a particular emotional state?* To transmit this internal state, the artist models and constructs a corresponding visual environment. However, when decoded by another observer, that identical visual environment may trigger a completely different emotional variable, resulting in a systemic conflict between context and affect. It is precisely this cognitive dissonance—this baseline inconsistency—that compels the observer to deepen their contemplation, allocate temporal resources, and achieve a higher-order, multi-layered comprehension.